

1. Introduction

This user manual describes how to connect to the SSH Stepstone via SSH. The Stepstone is a way to connect to services within the VU network from outside of the VU Network.

For example to access the Compute services or use remote control from outside the VU Network. To use this service you require a VU-net-id, a SSH client and a working internet connection.

Note:

If you are using Kerberos tickets to authenticate please read the information in [Chapter 5](#) of this user manual.

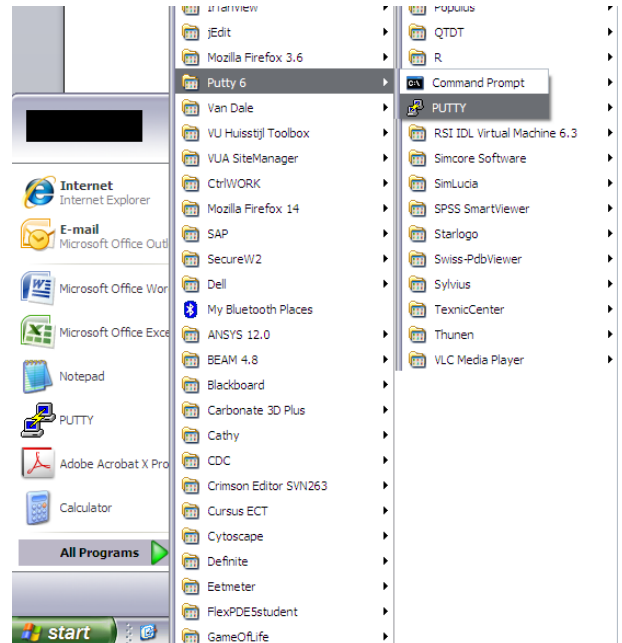
2. Windows: Putty

Start the SSH client application **Putty**

If you don't have Putty installed, download and install the application from:

<http://www.putty.org>

Or when you have a supported (green, orange) computer request this application via the UC-IT Servicedesk.



Enter the following under Session:

Host: **ssh.data.vu.nl**

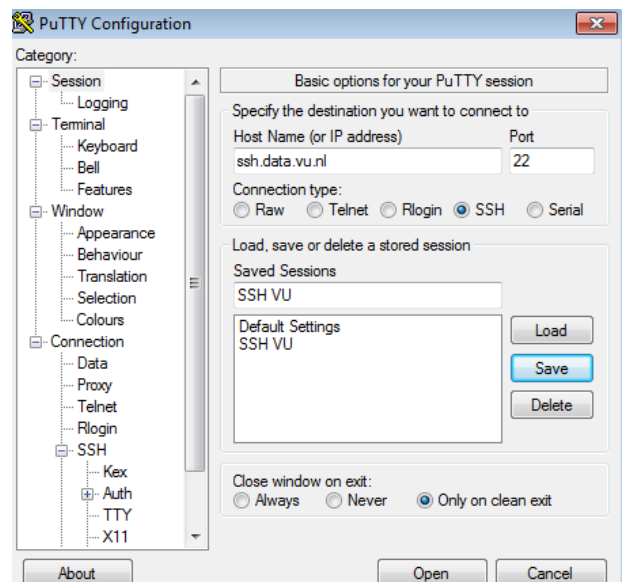
Port: **22**

Connection type: **SSH**

Saved Sessions: **SSH VU**

Click on **Save** (this ensures that the next time you start Putty you can quickly reload the setting by selecting the saved session and pressing the **Load** button).

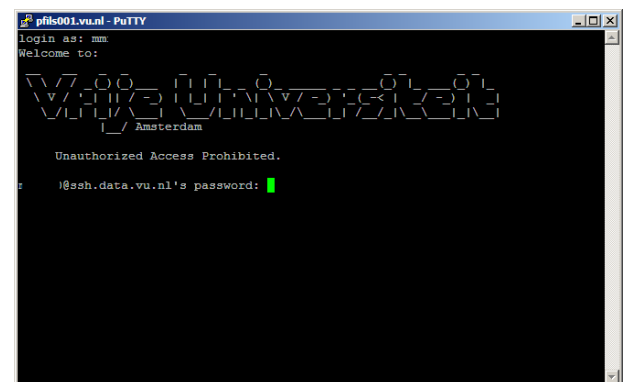
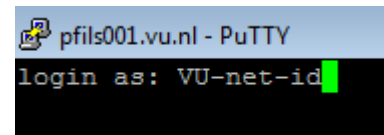
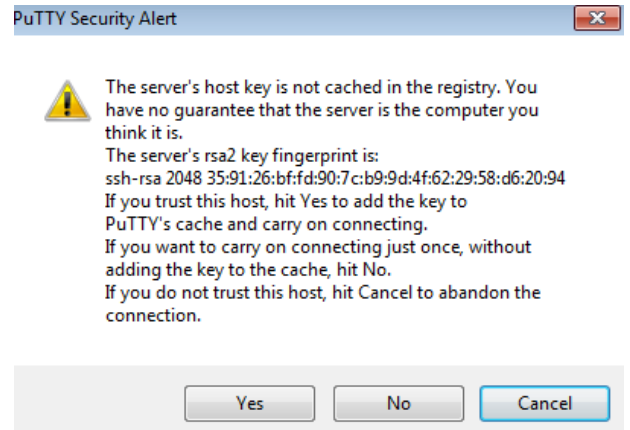
Click on **Open**



Accept the server's host key for the first time.

35:91:26:bf:fd:90:7c:b9:9d:4f:62:29:58:d6:20:94

Enter your VU-net-id username.
Enter your VU-net-id password.



3. Mac OSX: Terminal

Start the **Terminal** application from the *Utilities* folder located in the *applications* folder.

Enter the following:

ssh <VU-net-id>@ssh.data.vu.nl



Accept the server's host key for the first time.

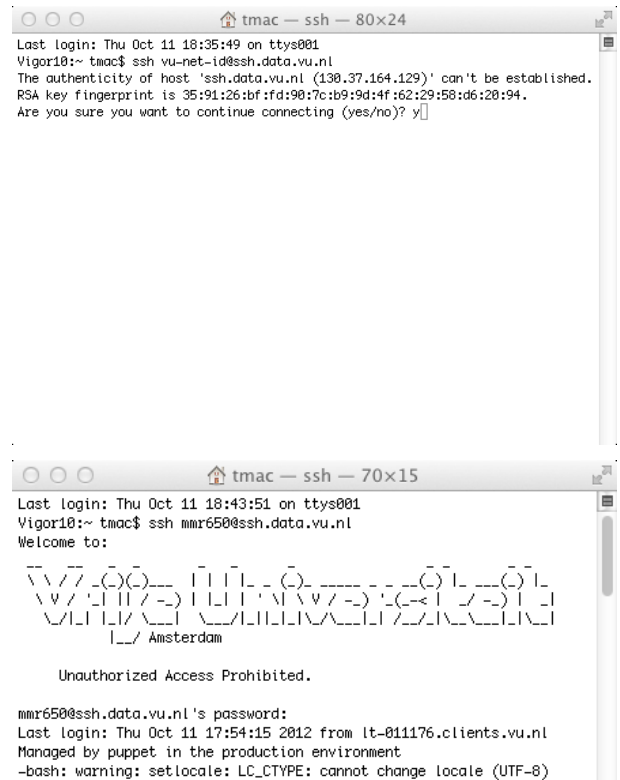
35:91:26:bf:fd:90:7c:b9:9d:4f:62:29:58:d6:20:94

Enter **Yes**

Enter your VU-net-id password.

Note:

If you are using a public/private keypair to authenticate and the login stalls, follow the instructions in [Chapter 5](#) to resolve this issue.



4. Linux: Console

Start the Console

Enter the following:

ssh <VU-net-id>@ssh.data.vu.nl

Accept the server's host key for the first time.

35:91:26:bf:fd:90:7c:b9:9d:4f:62:29:58:d6:20:94

Enter **Yes**

Enter your VU-net-id password.

Note:

If you are using a public/private keypair to authenticate and the login stalls, follow the instructions below to resolve this issue.

5. Expired kerberos ticket.

If you try to login to the SSH stepstone server using a valid account and you have set up a public/private keypair on your local machine, it is possible the login process will stall (freeze) when your Kerberos credentials on the server have expired. If this happens, all processes related to your login will hang to avoid errors, including the process that reads the `authorized_keys` file from your home directory.

The workaround

When using SSH from the command line under Linux or Mac OS you can append the option 'PreferredAuthentications=password' to the ssh process using the -o flag to ensure that authentication by password is attempted before private/public-key authentication. The full command to login to the server would then become:

ssh -o PreferredAuthentications=password <VU-net-id>@ssh.data.vu.nl

Upon succesfull authentication by password a new Kerberos ticket will automatically be created and any processes running under your credentials that need access to your user home can resume.

Prevention

Run **kdestroy** just before logging out if you only log in to the server incidentally. If you regularly log into a server then run the executable **kkeep** immediately after a password login to start a daemon that will periodically acquire a new Kerberos ticket using your cached credentials. This process will continue to work in the background until the server is rebooted and/or the process is terminated, or your password is changed, then you will have to manually restart the process on the server.